



Course# Online Journalism

Lec# 3

Scanning and Surfing

In online journalism, scanning and surfing are two different ways users interact with digital content:

1. Scanning:

Definition: Scanning refers to the way readers quickly look over or "scan" a webpage to find specific information or key points without reading the entire content in detail.

Purpose: Online readers often scan headlines, subheadings, bullet points, bolded text, or summaries to locate the most important or relevant information. This is common because digital content is usually vast, and users want to find what interests them quickly.

Example: A user might scan a news article by quickly looking at the headline, the introduction, and some highlighted or bolded quotes, rather than reading the full article from start to finish.

2. Surfing:

Definition: Surfing refers to the act of casually browsing or moving from one webpage to another, often without a specific goal in mind, just exploring content or searching for something interesting.

Purpose: Users surf when they are exploring the web, clicking through links, articles, or websites, and consuming various kinds of information. It's more about discovery than looking for specific details.

Example: A user might start on a news site, read a headline that catches their eye, and then follow links to related articles, videos, or other websites.

Key Difference:

Scanning is more focused and involves quickly finding specific information within a single piece of content.

Surfing is broader and involves moving from one piece of content or webpage to another, often for discovery or general browsing.

Both behaviors reflect how audiences interact with digital content in fast-paced online environments.